

Κράντωρ ὁ Σολεύς

Crantor of Soli on Plato's Atlantis

eul_aid: hhq

Period: [Κλασική](#) [Classical](#)
Dialect: [Ἀττική](#) [Attic \(phi, frg\)](#)
Domain: [Φιλοσοφία](#) [Philosophy](#)
Format: [Πραγματεία](#) [Treatise](#)
Affiliation: [Platonist](#)

Crantor of Soli was a Greek philosopher active in the late 4th and early 3rd centuries BCE. Originally from Soli in Cilicia, he moved to Athens to join Plato's Academy, where he studied under Xenocrates and was a colleague of Polemo. He lived during the early Hellenistic period, as new philosophical schools like Stoicism were emerging.

As a member of the early Academy, Crantor is significant for being one of the first philosophers to systematically interpret Plato's works. His most notable contribution was writing the first known commentary on Plato's dialogue *Timaeus*. This commentary was highly influential and was used by later Platonists for centuries, helping to establish the *Timaeus* as a foundational text for theories about the cosmos and creation.

Crantor was also famous for a treatise titled *On Grief*, which is considered a pioneering work in the genre of consolation literature. Written to comfort a father on the loss of his children, it argued for moderation in mourning. This work was widely admired, cited by Cicero in his own writings on grief, and known to later Greek and Christian authors.

Although his own writings survive only in fragments quoted by later authors, Crantor's role was crucial. He helped bridge the philosophy of Plato's immediate successors with the developing thought of the Hellenistic age. Some scholars note that his ethical definition of the highest good as "life in accordance with nature" shows an early interaction with ideas that would later be central to Stoicism.

Works (2)

- [Ἀποσπάσματα](#) · [Commentary on Plato's Atlantis](#) · 12 passages
- [Ἀποσπάσματα καὶ Τίτλος](#) · [Fragments and Title](#) · 2 passages

Other Platonist Authors

- [Ἀλβῖνος ὁ Πλατωνικός](#) · [Albinus the Platonist](#) · 2 works
- [Ἀλέξανδρος Λυκοπολίτης](#) · [Alexander of Lycopolis](#) · 1 work
- [Ἀνώνυμος ὑπόμνημα εἰς τὸν Πλάτωνος Θεαίτητον](#) · [Anonymous Commentary on Plato](#) · 1 work
- [Ἀρίμνηστος](#) · [Arimnestus the Philosopher](#) · 1 work
- [Ἀττικός](#) · [Atticus the Philosopher](#) · 1 work
- [Κάσσιος Λογγῖνος](#) · [Cassius Longinus the Philosopher](#) · 3 works

- Κέλσος ὁ Πλατωνικός · Celsus the Platonist · 1 work
- Ἡρακλείδης ὁ Ποντικός · Heraclides of Pontus · 2 works
- Ἡρακλείδης ὁ Ποντικός · Heraclides of Pontus II · 1 work
- Ἡρακλείδης ὁ Ποντικός · Heraclides of Pontus III · 1 work
- Ἀνώνυμος Προλεγόμενα εἰς τὴν Πλατωνικὴν Φιλοσοφίαν · Introduction Platonism Anonymous · 1 work
- Νουμήνιος ὁ ἐξ Ἀπαμείας · Numenius of Apamea · 1 work